

Add and Manage Plants in OrchidApp

User guide for creating plant records and using the Plant Details page

Purpose

Use this guide after OrchidApp has been installed and the initial setup has been completed.

It explains how to add a plant, understand the Plant Details page, record day-to-day events and manage photos, flowering, repotting, movement, splitting and propagation.

Before you start

- Add the plant group (genus) first.
- Add the species / hybrid before adding the plant.
- Each plant gets a permanent Plant Tag automatically when it is saved.
- Use events to build the plant history over time rather than editing notes into one large record.

Typical workflow

1. Open Plants from the Home screen or the top menu.
2. Choose Add plant.
3. Select the species / hybrid.
4. Enter acquisition details and save the plant.
5. Use the Plant Details page to add observations, photos, movements, flowering and repotting records.

Quick reference: Plant Details actions

Action	Use it for	Result
Add observation	General notes or quick observations, including photo observations.	Adds an observation card to the plant history.
Move plant	Recording that the plant has moved to a new growing location.	Updates current location and keeps previous locations in history.
Add flowering	Recording a flowering period, spike count, flower count and notes.	Adds flowering to history and updates the summary on the Plant Details page.
Add repotting	Recording potting medium, root condition, pot size and reason for repotting.	Adds repotting to history and updates the repotting summary.
Split plant	Ending one plant and creating two or more new independent plants.	Parent becomes ended/read-only. Child plants receive new permanent Plant Tags.
Propagate plant	Creating a new plant while keeping the existing plant alive.	Creates a new plant linked to the original plant as provenance.
Tap image	Opening the plant photo page.	Lets you browse photos, upload more and set the main image.

1. Open Plants

You can open Plants from either the Home screen or the top menu. Both take you to the same place.



The Plants option is available from the top menu.



Plants

View and manage your collection

Select a species / hybrid to view its plants.

Add plant

← Back

On the Plants page, choose Add plant to create a new plant record.

2. Add a plant

Select the species / hybrid

OrchidApp first asks which species / hybrid the new plant belongs to. This is why the species / hybrid should already exist before adding a plant.



Add plant

Select the genus and species / hybrid

Choose the botanical name for the new plant. You'll enter the plant's details next.

Cattleya



reference image

Cattleya rex



reference image

Cattleya sp.

← Back

Choose the botanical name for the plant.

Enter plant details

The plant name is optional. The acquisition date and source are useful for collection history, but they can be left blank if unknown.

OrchidApp Home Plants Reports Setup

Search by tag

Find

Add plant

Cattleya rex

This plant will be recorded under this species / hybrid. A permanent Plant Tag (ID) will be created automatically after saving.

Plant name

Optional. A personal name to help you recognise this plant.

Acquired on

Optional. The date you obtained the plant. Leave blank if unknown.

02 / 02 / 2025



Acquired from

Optional. Where the plant came from (e.g. nursery, friend, swap).

McBeans

Plant notes

Optional. Any additional notes about this plant.

← Back

Add plant

Enter optional plant details before saving.

3. Save the plant and note the Plant Tag

Use the date picker for the acquisition date. When you save, OrchidApp automatically creates a permanent Plant Tag. This tag is the plant's stable ID and should not be changed or reused. It is recommended that the plant label includes the Plant Tag.

Cattleya rex

This plant will be recorded under this species / hybrid. A permanent Plant Tag (ID) will be created automatically after saving.

Plant name

Optional. A personal name to help you recognise this plant.

Acquired on

Optional. The date you obtained the plant. Leave blank if unknown.

dd / mm / yyyy

<May 2026>

Mon

Tue

Wed

Thu

Fri

Sat

Sun

27

28

29

30

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

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11

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21

22

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28

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30

31

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

Clear

nursery, friend, swap).

ant.

Use the date picker for the acquisition date, if known.

Plant added

Cattleya rex

Plant Tag (permanent id)

TI3-9403

Acquired on

02/02/2025

Source

McBeans

Name

—

Continue

After saving, OrchidApp displays the new permanent Plant Tag.

4. Understand the Plant Details page

The Plant Details page is the main working page for each plant. It shows the permanent Plant Tag, current location, acquisition details, recent repotting and flowering information, plus the plant history.

Cattleya rex

Plant details

Plant tag	T13 - 9403	Edit
Location	Intermediate Greenhouse	
Repotting	Repotted 20/06/2025 into Bark	
Acquisition	Acquired 02/02/2025 from McBeans	
Flowering	Last flowered 28/10/2025	



Tap image to view photos

History

[Add observation](#)

[Move plant](#)

[Add flowering](#)

[Add repotting](#)

Splitting ends this plant and creates new plants. Propagation (Keiki, Backbulb, Cuttings) creates a new plant while keeping this one.

[Split plant](#)

[Propagate plant](#)

[Observation](#)

10/11/2025

Photo added

[Edit event](#)

[Remove event](#)

[Flowering](#)

28/10/2025

Flowered FROM 28-10-2025 to 08-01-2026 with 11 flowers over 2 spikes

[Edit event](#)

[Remove event](#)

[Repotting](#)

20/06/2025

Repotted into Bark - Leaves floppy and generally looking sick

[Edit event](#)

[Remove event](#)

[Observation](#)

13/05/2025

Leaves are too floppy

[Edit event](#)

[Remove event](#)

[Move](#)

02/02/2025

Moved to Intermediate Greenhouse on 02-02-2025 (current)

[Edit event](#)

[Remove event](#)

The Plant Details page shows the current plant summary and history actions.

- The Edit button changes basic plant details for corrections or setting the flowering end date.
- The large blue buttons add new history records.
- History cards show observations, moves, flowering and repotting in date order.
- The plant image opens the Photos page when tapped.

5. Add an observation

Use observations for ordinary notes about the plant, such as leaf condition, root growth, pests or general care comments.

1. Open the plant.
2. Choose Add observation.
3. Enter the observation date.
4. Type the notes.
5. Choose Add Observation.

Cattleya rex

Plant details

Plant tag

T13-9403

Edit

Location

Intermediate Greenhouse

Acquisition

Acquired 02/02/2025 from McBeans

History

Add observation

Move plant

Add flowering

Add repotting

Splitting ends this plant and creates new plants. Propagation (Keiki, Backbulb, Cuttings) creates a new plant while keeping this one.

Split plant

Propagate plant

Move

02/02/2025

Moved to Intermediate Greenhouse on 02-02-2025 (current)

Edit event

Remove event

← Back

Add a general observation.

Cattleya rex

Plant details

Plant tag

T13-9403

Edit

Location

Intermediate Greenhouse

Acquisition

Acquired 02/02/2025 from McBeans

History

Add observation

Move plant

Add flowering

Add repotting

Splitting ends this plant and creates new plants. Propagation (Keiki, Backbulb, Cuttings) creates a new plant while keeping this one.

Split plant

Propagate plant

Observation

13/05/2025

Leaves are too floppy

Edit event

Remove event

Move

02/02/2025

Moved to Intermediate Greenhouse on 02-02-2025 (current)

Edit event

Remove event

The observation appears in the plant history.

6. Add a photo observation

Photos are added through observations. Use Add photo when the main purpose of the observation is to attach one or more plant photos.

Add Observation

Cattleya rex

TI3 - 9403

Record something you've noticed about this plant.

Choose a quick action or add general notes below.

 Add photo

 Feed (growth)

 Feed (bloom)

Observation date
12 / 05 / 2026 

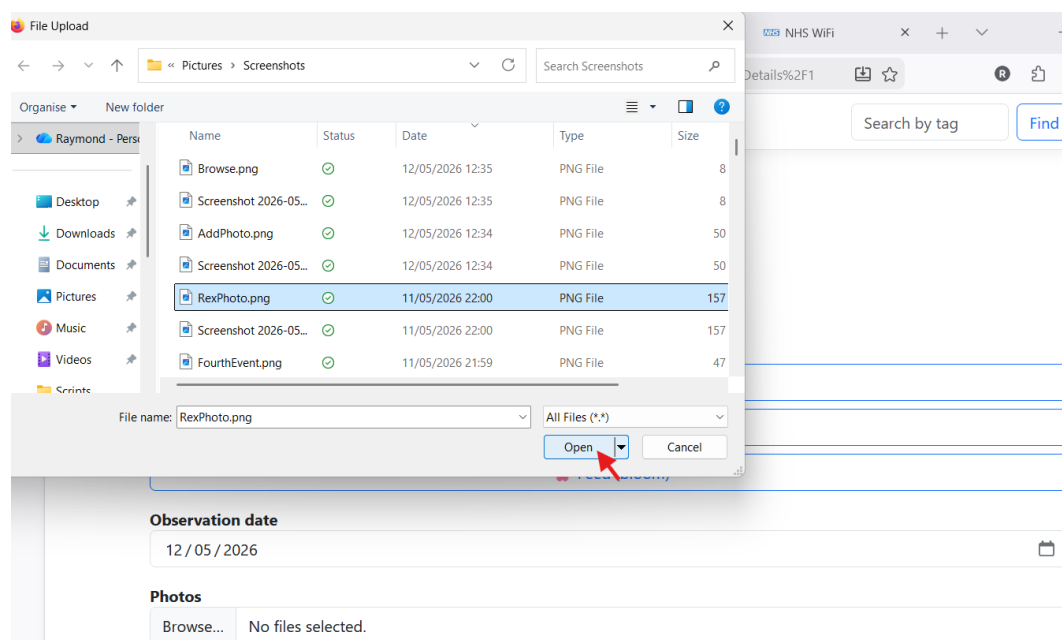
Notes
e.g. Noticed new root growth, leaves firm and glossy

Add Observation

Back

Choose Add photo on the observation screen.

Choose Browse, select the image file and then save the observation. The photo observation is added to the history.



Select the photo file and choose Open.

7. Use the Photos page

Tap the plant image on the Plant Details page to open the Photos page. This page is for browsing all plant photos, uploading more and choosing the main image.

Cattleya rex

Plant details

Plant tag	TI3-9403	Edit
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Tap image to view photos

History

Add observation

Move plant

Add flowering

Add repotting

Splitting ends this plant and creates new plants. Propagation (Keiki, Backbulb, Cuttings) creates a new plant while keeping this one.

Split plant

Propagate plant

Observation 12/02/2026

Photo added

Edit event

Remove event

Observation 10/11/2025

Photo added

Edit event

Remove event

Tap the plant image to open the Photos page.

Photos

Cattleya rex

Tag	TI3-9403
Location	Intermediate Greenhouse



Main image

Tap a thumbnail below to view a different photo.

Previous photo

Next photo



Add photos

Photos

You can select more than one photo.

Browse... No files selected.

Notes

Optional.

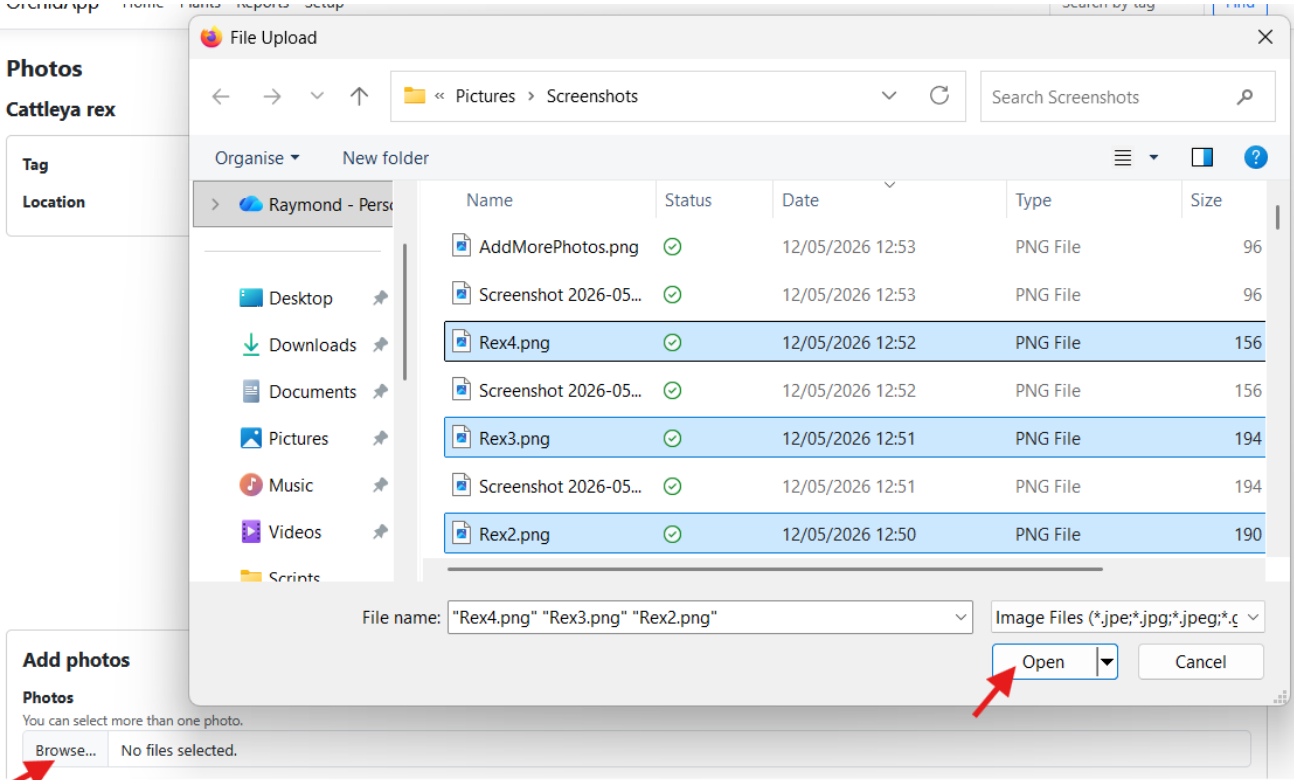
Upload photos

Back

The Photos page shows the focused photo, thumbnails and upload controls.

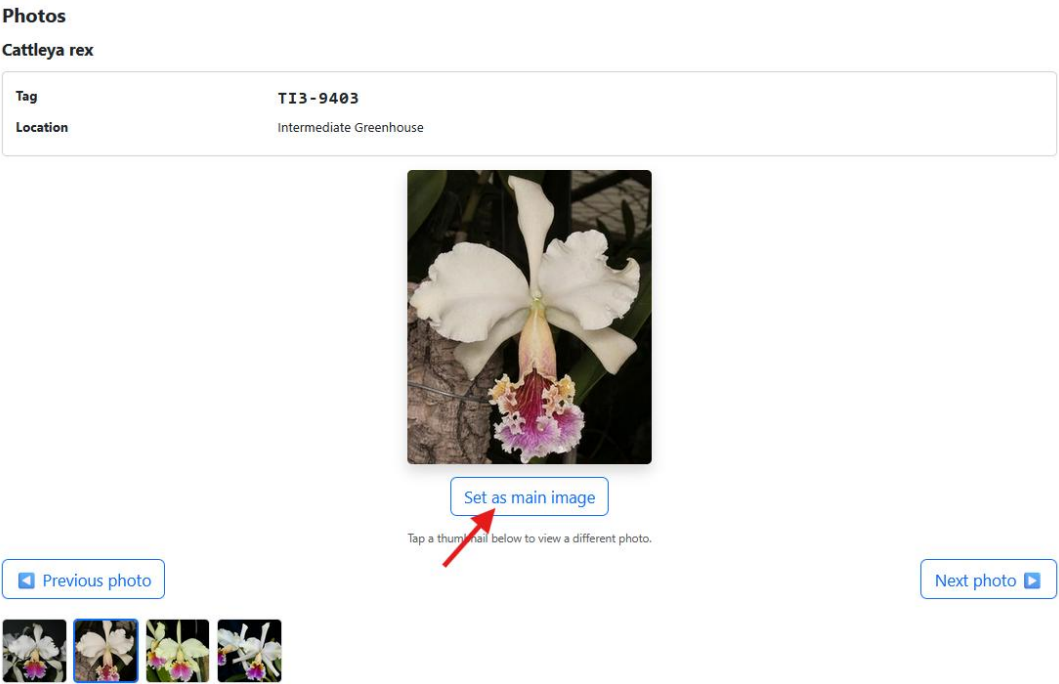
8. Upload more photos and set the main image

On the Photos page, you can upload more than one image at a time. Select the files, choose Open and then upload them.



Select multiple photos before uploading.

When viewing a photo that is not currently the main image, choose Set as main image. The Plant Details page then shows the selected photo as the plant image.



Choose Set as main image to update the plant's main photo.

9. Move a plant

Use Move plant when the plant changes growing location. This updates the current location and preserves previous locations in the plant history.

- 1. Choose Move plant on the Plant Details page.
- 2. Select the new location.
- 3. Enter the move date.
- 4. Add a move reason or location notes if useful.
- 5. Choose Move Plant.

OrchidApp

HomePlantsReportsSetup

Search by tagFind

Move Plant

Cattleya rex

TI3-9403

Record that this plant has been moved to a new location.

This records when the plant moved. Previous locations will be kept in its history.

Location

Intermediate Greenhouse

Move date

02 / 02 / 2025

Move reason

Location notes

Move Plant

Back

Record a plant move to a new location.

OrchidApp

HomePlantsReportsSetup

Search by tagFind

Cattleya rex

Plant details

Plant tag

TI3-9403

Location

—

Acquisition

Acquired 02/02/2025 from McBeans

Edit

History

Add observation

Move plant

Add flowering

Add repotting

Splitting ends this plant and creates new plants. Propagation (Keiki, Backbulb, Cuttings) creates a new plant while keeping this one.

Split plant

Propagate plant

No events recorded yet.

← Back

The current location is shown in the plant summary.

10. Add flowering

Use Add flowering to record when a plant flowers. Leave the end date blank if the plant is still flowering.

- Start date records when flowering began.
- End date is optional and can be added later.
- Spike count and flower count help with future comparisons.
- Notes can capture anything useful about the flowering.

OrchidApp

HomePlantsReportsSetup

Search by tag

Find

Add Flowering

Cattleya rex

TI3 - 9403

Record a flowering period for this plant.

Start date

Date flowering began.

28 / 10 / 2025

End date (optional)

dd / mm / yyyy

Leave blank if currently flowering.

Spike count

2

Flower count

11

Notes

Add Flowering

Back

Record a flowering period.

Cattleya rex**Plant details**

Plant tag	T13-9403	Edit
Location	Intermediate Greenhouse	
Repotting	Repotted 20/06/2025 into Bark	
Acquisition	Acquired 02/02/2025 from McBeans	
Flowering	Last flowered 28/10/2025	

History

[Add observation](#) [Move plant](#) [Add flowering](#) [Add repotting](#)

Splitting ends this plant and creates new plants. Propagation (Keiki, Backbulb, Cuttings) creates a new plant while keeping this one.

[Split plant](#) [Propagate plant](#)

Flowering 28/10/2025

Flowered FROM 28-10-2025 (currently flowering) with 11 flowers over 2 spikes

[Edit event](#) [Remove event](#)

Repotting 20/06/2025

Repotted into Bark - Leaves floppy and generally looking sick

[Edit event](#) [Remove event](#)

Observation 13/05/2025

Leaves are too floppy

[Edit event](#) [Remove event](#)

Move 02/02/2025

Moved to Intermediate Greenhouse on 02-02-2025 (current)

[Edit event](#) [Remove event](#)

[← Back](#)

Flowering appears in the history and summary.

11. Edit flowering when it ends

If you left the end date blank, use Edit event on the flowering history card when flowering has finished. Add the end date and save.

Cattleya rex

Plant details

Plant tag	TI3 - 9403	Edit
Location	Intermediate Greenhouse	
Repotting	Repotted 20/06/2025 into Bark	
Acquisition	Acquired 02/02/2025 from McBeans	
Flowering	Last flowered 28/10/2025	



Tap image to view photos

History

[Add observation](#)

[Move plant](#)

[Add flowering](#)

[Add repotting](#)

Splitting ends this plant and creates new plants. Propagation (Keiki, Backbulb, Cuttings) creates a new plant while keeping this one.

Split plant

Propagate plant

Observation

10/11/2025

Photo added

[Edit event](#)

[Remove event](#)

Flowering

28/10/2025

Flowered FROM 28-10-2025 (currently flowering) with 11 flowers over 2 spikes

[Edit event](#)

[Remove event](#)

Repotting

10/06/2025

Repotted into Bark - Leaves floppy and generally looking sick

[Edit event](#)

[Remove event](#)

Observation

13/05/2025

Leaves are too floppy

[Edit event](#)

[Remove event](#)

Move

02/02/2025

Moved to Intermediate Greenhouse on 02-02-2025 (current)

[Edit event](#)

[Remove event](#)

Add the flowering end date when the flowering period ends.

Edit flowering

Cattleya rex
TI3 - 9403

Update this flowering record.

Flowering started on

28 / 10 / 2025

Flowering ended on

08 / 01 / 2026

Spike count

2

Flower count

11

Notes

Edit flowering

Back

The flowering history updates after editing

12. Add repotting

Use Add repotting to record potting changes, medium condition and the reason for repotting. This helps build a useful care history.

- Previous growing medium describes what the plant was in before repotting.
- Condition notes capture root or medium condition.
- New growing medium records what the plant was repotted into.
- Reason for repotting explains why the change was made.

Add Repotting

Cattleya rex
T13-9403

Record when this plant was repotted and the growing medium used. Repotting history helps track root health and understand how long a plant has been in its current medium.

Repotting date

The date the plant was repotted.

20 / 06 / 2025

Previous growing medium

Medium

The medium the plant was growing in before repotting.

— unknown or not recorded —

Condition notes

Optional notes such as broken down bark, compacted moss, or root condition.

Very broken down growth medium. Roots crowded

New pot and medium

New growing medium

The medium used after repotting.

Bark

Medium notes

Optional details such as bark size, moss mix, or additives used.

Pot size

The pot size used after repotting (e.g. 9 cm, 4 inch).

Reason for repotting

Optional. For example: medium breaking down, roots overcrowded, or moving to a larger pot.

Leaves floppy and generally looking sick

Additional notes

Any other observations during repotting such as root condition or pests.

Add Repotting

Back

Record repotting details and save.

Cattleya rex

Plant details

Plant tag	T13-9403	Edit
Location	Intermediate Greenhouse	
Repotting	Repotted 20/06/2025 into Bark	
Acquisition	Acquired 02/02/2025 from McBeans	

History

Add observation	Move plant	Add flowering	Add repotting
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Splitting ends this plant and creates new plants. Propagation (Keiki, Backbulb, Cuttings) creates a new plant while keeping this one.

Split plant	Propagate plant
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🔄 Repotting 20/06/2025 Repotted into Bark - Leaves floppy and generally looking sick Edit event Remove event
📅 Observation 13/05/2025 Leaves are too floppy Edit event Remove event
📍 Move 02/02/2025 Moved to Intermediate Greenhouse on 02-02-2025 (current) Edit event Remove event

The repotting record appears in the history and updates the summary.

13. Edit or remove history events

Each history card has Edit event and Remove event buttons where the event type allows changes. Use these to correct mistakes rather than creating duplicate records.

Use Remove event carefully. For ordinary corrections, editing the existing event is usually better than removing it and adding a new one.

14. Split or propagate a plant

Split and propagation are more advanced than ordinary history events. They both create new plant records, but they mean different things.

- Split plant ends the original plant and creates two or more new independent plants. Use it when the original plant has been divided and no longer exists as one plant.
- Propagate plant creates a new plant while keeping the original plant active. Use it for keiki, backbulb, cutting or similar propagation.

Cattleya rex

Plant details

Plant tag	T13-9403	Edit
Location	Intermediate Greenhouse	
Repotting	Repotted 20/06/2025 into Bark	
Acquisition	Acquired 02/02/2025 from McBeans	
Flowering	Last flowered 28/10/2025	



Tap image to view photos

History

Add observation

Move plant

Add flowering

Add repotting

Splitting ends this plant and creates new plants. Propagation (Keiki, Backbulb, Cuttings) creates a new plant while keeping this one.

Split plant

Propagate plant

Use Propagate plant when the original plant remains active.

Cattleya rex

Plant details

Plant tag	T13-9403	Edit
Location	Intermediate Greenhouse	
Repotting	Repotted 20/06/2025 into Bark	
Acquisition	Acquired 02/02/2025 from McBeans	
Flowering	Last flowered 28/10/2025	



Tap image to view photos

History

Add observation

Move plant

Add flowering

Add repotting

Splitting ends this plant and creates new plants. Propagation (Keiki, Backbulb, Cuttings) creates a new plant while keeping this one.

Split plant

Propagate plant

Observation 12/02/2026

Photo added

[Edit event](#)

[Remove event](#)

Use Split plant when the original plant is ending and becoming new plants.

15. Split a plant

Splitting is permanent. OrchidApp warns that the original plant will end and new plants will be created.

Split plant

Cattleya rex
TI3-9403

This split will end this plant's lifecycle on the date and you choose and create new independent plants. The original plant will remain in your records and its full history will still be available to view.

New plants will be given permanent IDs automatically.

Split date

16 / 03 / 2026

Reason for split

Optional. Use this to record why the plant was divided.

Overgrown

Split notes

Optional. Any additional notes about the outcome of the split.

New plants

Two new plants are shown by default. Add more if needed. Plant permanent IDs will be created automatically.

New plant 1

Growth medium

Optional. The starting growth medium for this plant.

Bark

Plant name

Optional. A personal name to help you recognise this plant.

New plant 2

Growth medium

Optional. The starting growth medium for this plant.

Bark

Plant name

Optional. A personal name to help you recognise this plant.

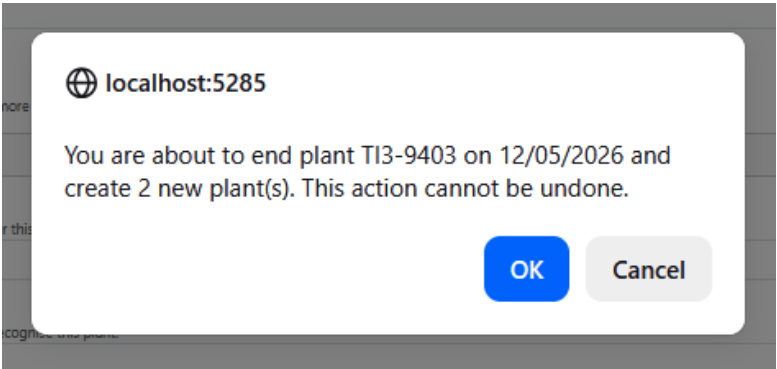
Add another new plant

This will end plant TI3-9403 on 12/05/2026 and create 2 new plant(s). This action cannot be undone.

← Back

Confirm split (ends this plant)

Enter the split date, reason, notes and the details for each new plant.



Confirm the split only when you are sure.

16. After a split

After the split, OrchidApp shows the new permanent IDs. The original plant becomes ended and read-only. The new child plants are linked back to the parent through heritage.

Plant split completed

Cattleya rex

The split has created the following new plants.

New plant 1 permanent ID

RU2 - 5587

New plant 2 permanent ID

SI8 - 1465

Continue to first new plant

The split creates new plant IDs.

Cattleya rex

Ended

Plant details

This plant has ended and is read-only.

Plant tag

Location

Repotting

Acquisition

Flowering

TI3 - 9403

Intermediate Greenhouse

Repotted 20/06/2025 into Bark

Acquired 02/02/2025 from McBeans

Last flowered 28/10/2025

View details



Tap image to view photos

Heritage

Child (Split)

RU2 - 5587

Created 16/03/2026

Child (Split)

SI8 - 1465

Created 16/03/2026

View full lineage

History

Add observation

Move plant

Add flowering

Add repotting

Observation

12/02/2026

Photo added

Observation

10/11/2025

Photo added

Flowering

28/10/2025

Flowered FROM 28-10-2025 to 08-01-2026 with 11 flowers over 2 spikes

Repotting

20/06/2025

Repotted into Bark - Leaves floppy and generally looking sick

The ended parent remains visible and read-only, with child plants shown in Heritage.

17. View plant heritage

When a plant has a parent or child relationship, the Heritage section appears on the Plant Details page. Use it to move between related plants and view the full lineage.

Cattleya rex

Plant details

Plant tag

RU2-5587

Edit

Location

Intermediate Greenhouse

Repotting

Repotted 16/03/2026 into Bark

Acquisition

Acquired 16/03/2026 from Split from TI3-9403

Heritage

↑ Parent (Split)

TI3-9403

Ended 16/03/2026

View full lineage

History

Add observation

Move plant

Add flowering

Add repotting

A child plant shows its parent in the Heritage section.

Cattleya rex

Plant details

Plant tag

RU2-5587

Edit

Location

—

Repotting

Repotted 16/03/2026 into Bark

Acquisition

Acquired 16/03/2026 from Split from TI3-9403

Heritage

↑ Parent (Split)

TI3-9403

Ended 16/03/2026

View full lineage

History

Add observation

Move plant

Add flowering

Add repotting

Splitting ends this plant and creates new plants. Propagation (Keiki, Backbulb, Cuttings) creates a new plant while keeping this one.

Split plant

Propagate plant

Repotting

16/03/2026

Repotted into Bark - Initial medium from split

Edit event

Remove event

← Back

A child plant has its own Plant Tag and its own independent history.

Plant management checklist

- Create the genus and species / hybrid before adding the plant.

- Use Add plant for each individual plant in the collection.
- Record ordinary care notes as observations.
- Add photos through observations or the Photos page.
- Use Move plant for location changes.
- Use Add flowering and Add repotting for structured care history.
- Use Split plant only when the original plant ends.
- Use Propagate plant when the original plant stays active.
- Use the Plant Tag to find and identify the plant later.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Do not create a new plant just because it moved location.
- Do not create a new plant just because it was repotted.
- Do not split a plant unless the original plant is ending.
- Do not rely on memory for plant identity: use the Plant Tag.